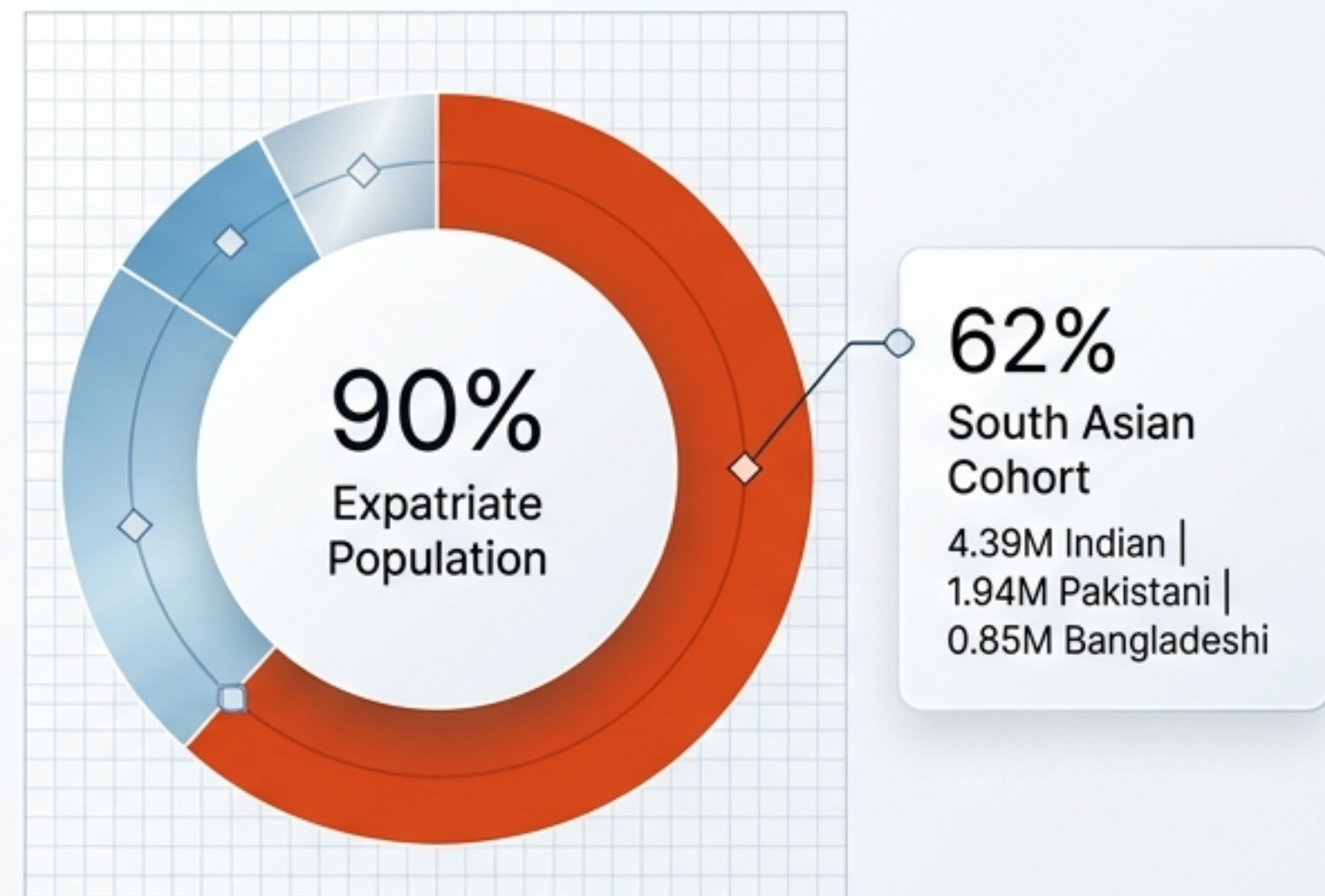
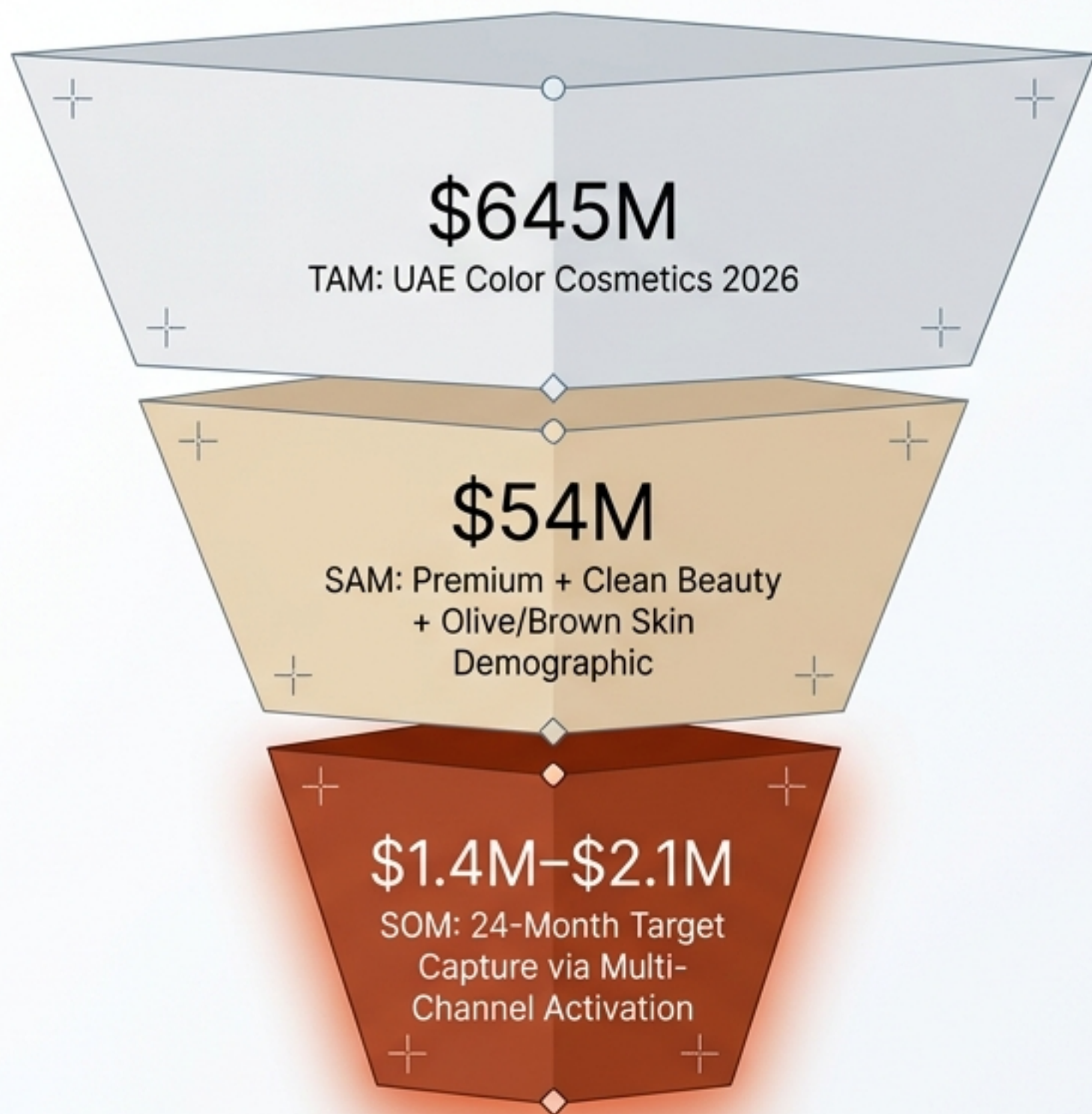




ZERO Makeup: UAE Expansion & Regulatory Roadmap 2026

Beyond Shopify: Activating the
Full GCC Beauty Ecosystem

[Operational Blueprint & Strategic Intent | Confidential]



The Demographic Asymmetry: Western brands chronically underserve this 7-million-strong demographic. Nabila's six-tier palette system explicitly solves the "ashy oxidation" problem for melanin-rich, olive, and golden undertones.

Asteri Beauty

Core Positioning: Desert-proof, Barrier repair, Arab Beauty.

Hero Product: Skincare-infused cosmetics & Facekits.

Price Point: Premium (\$110 - \$122 kits).

Value Driver: Extreme climate endurance.

Hindash Cosmetics

Core Positioning: Professional Artistry, High-pigment, Vegan.

Hero Product: Beautopsy Gradient Multi-use Palette.

Price Point: Premium Artistry (\$71).

Value Driver: Customization and dramatic aesthetic outcomes.

ZERO Makeup

Core Positioning: Minimalist, Quick, South Asian skin tones.

Hero Product: All-in-one Perfecting Palette.

Price Point: Accessible Masstige (~\$17 - \$25 / PKR 4,900 eq).

Value Driver: Speed, Simplicity, Multi-purpose.

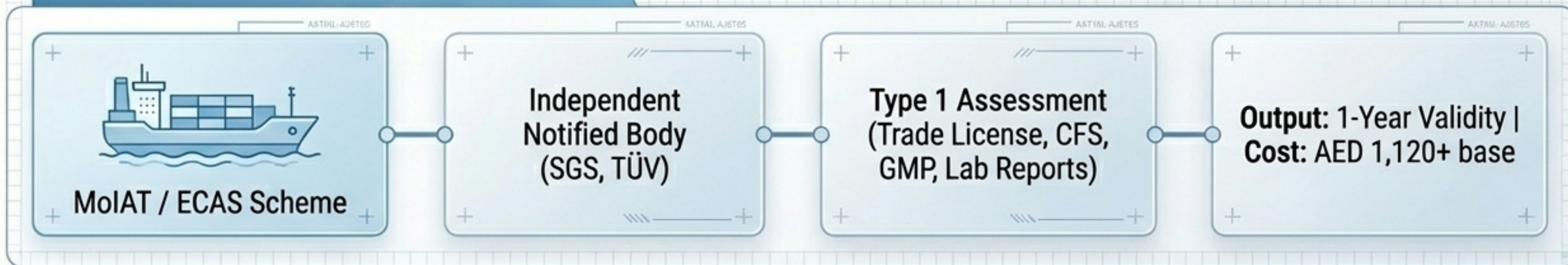
ZERO avoids head-to-head battles over dramatic pigmentation or heavy desert-proofing. It wins on ultra-efficient demographic calibration for the fast-paced UAE expatriate lifestyle.

Dual-Gate

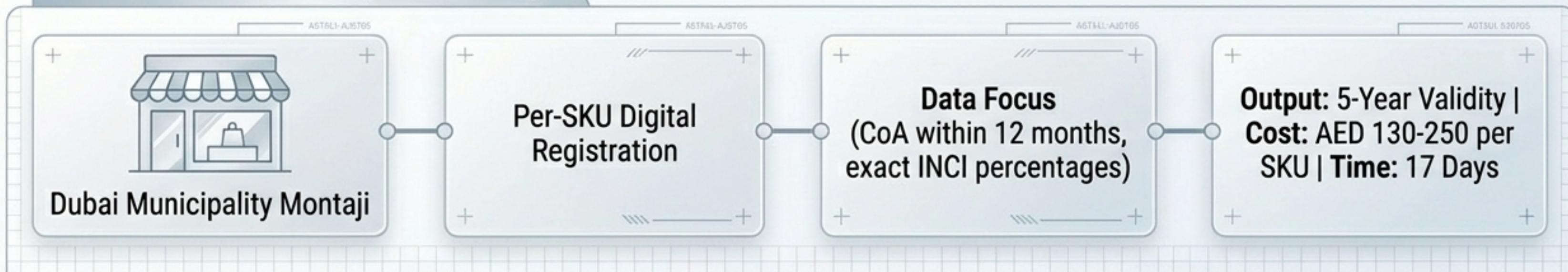


The 2026 Mandate: GSO 1943:2024 expands mandatory fragrance allergen labeling from 24 to 80 allergens. Deadline: Dec 31, 2026. Legacy labels trigger immediate customs seizure.

Track 1: Federal Mandate (Permits Import)

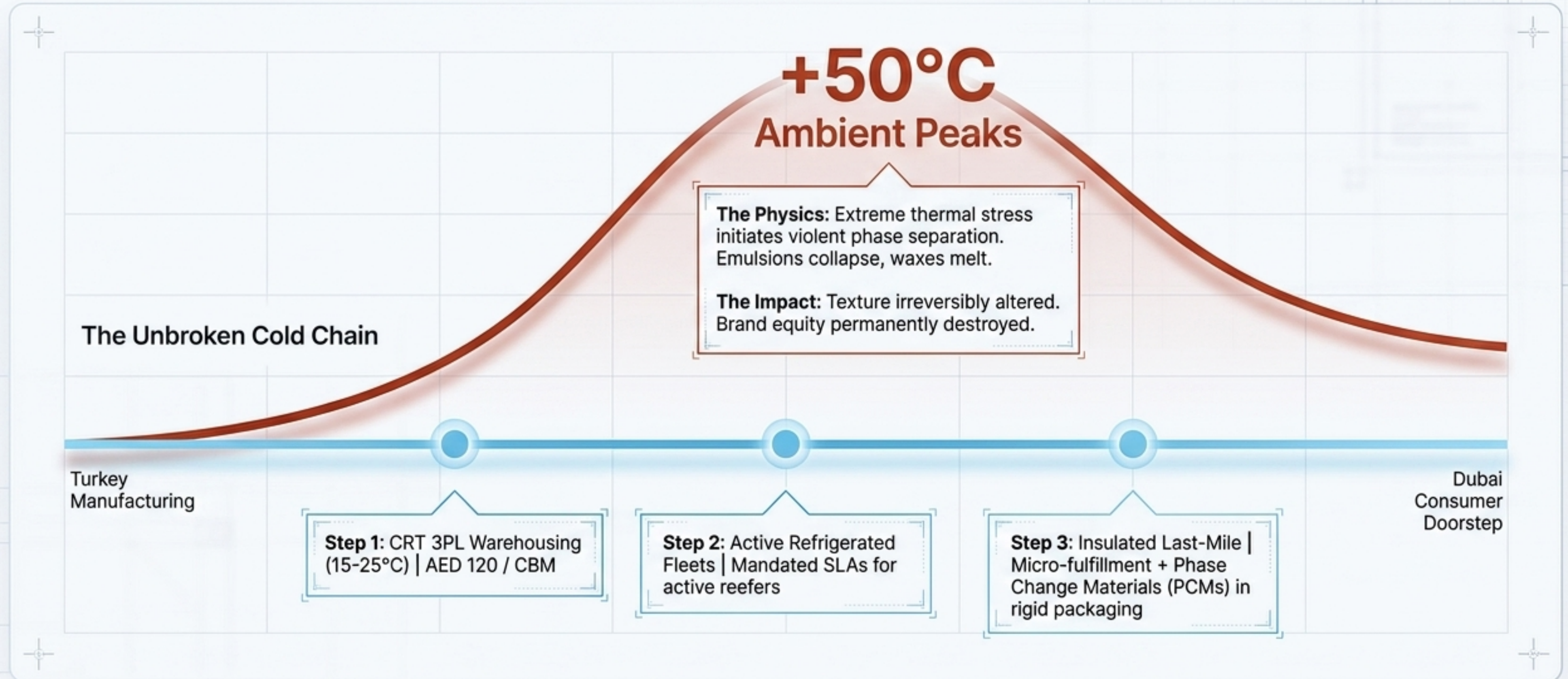


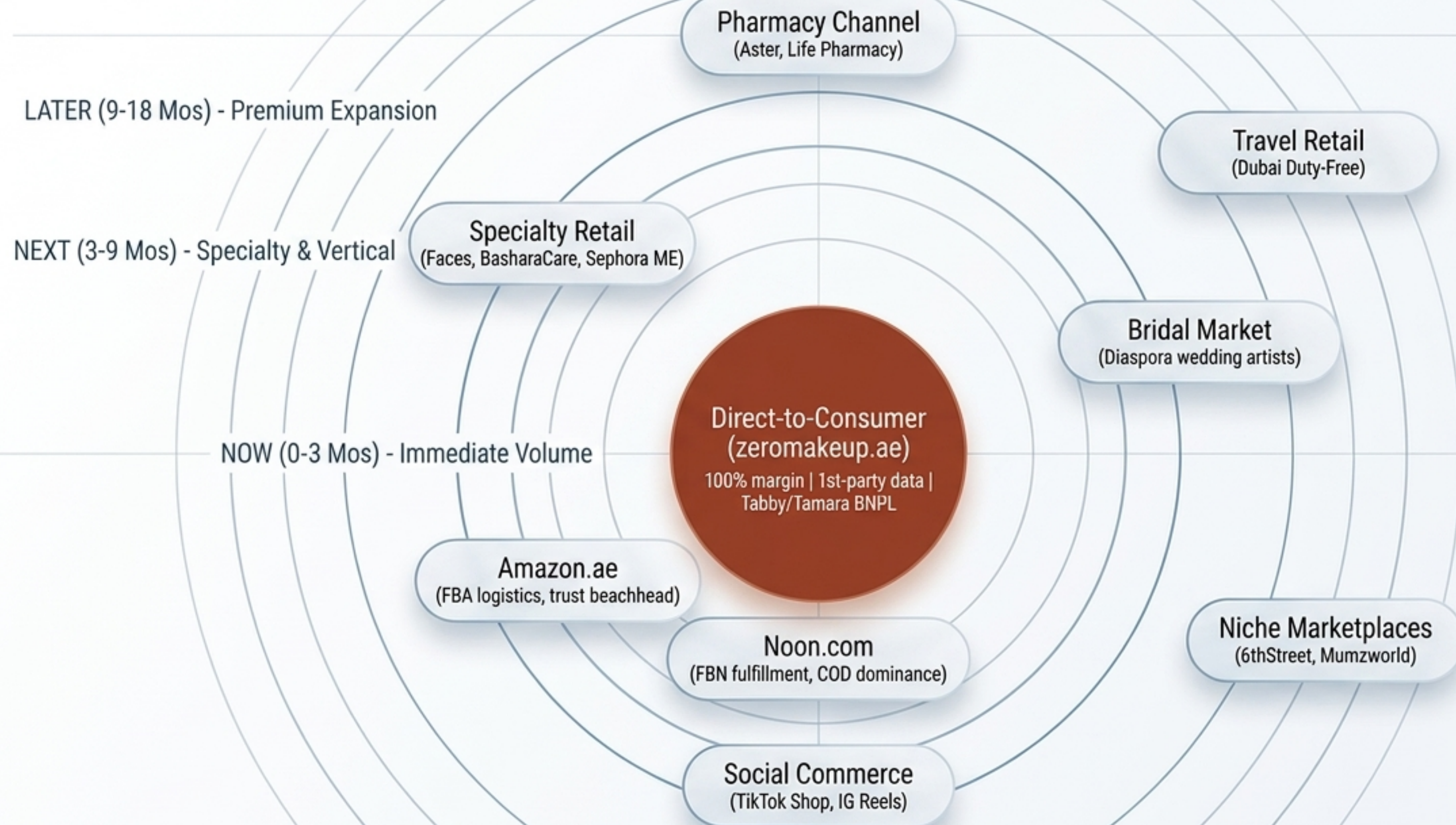
Track 2: Local Mandate (Permits Sale)



The Thermal Challenge:

Unbroken Cold-Chain vs. The Hazard Zone





Single-channel Shopify captures only 30-40% of intent. Multi-channel architecture is required to capture the full \$2.1M SOM.

Amazon.ae (The Trust Beachhead)



Account Hurdle: Foreign entities accepted directly (Zero local trade license friction).



Fulfillment: FBA (Flawless next-day for Prime). High long-term storage fees.



Economics: 15% referral fee for color cosmetics > AED 36. AED 184/mo subscription.



Peak Catalyst: Prime Day (Mid-July). Captures summer digital cash flow.

Noon.com (The Cultural Amplifier)



Account Hurdle: Strictly requires local UAE trade license (Walled garden).



Fulfillment: FBN. Massive dominance in Cash-on-Delivery (COD).



Economics: 14% referral fee for color cosmetics > AED 50. Zero monthly subscription fee.



Peak Catalyst: Yellow Friday (Late November). Targets GCC gifting season.

Strategic Sequencing: Sequence, do not overlap. Launch Amazon instantly for foreign-entity ease. Launch Noon post-trade license to capture the massive local COD market.

Tier 1: Brand Halo

Profile: Founder Nabila + Macro Creators
Volume: 1-4 / qtr
Objective: Authority (e.g., 12-week 'GRWM in 50°C' series)

Tier 2: Demographic Resonance

Profile: Mid-tier Diaspora (Pakistani, Indian, Emirati creators)
Volume: 8-15 / qtr
Objective: Targeted reach within the 62% South Asian moat

Tier 3: The Volume Engine

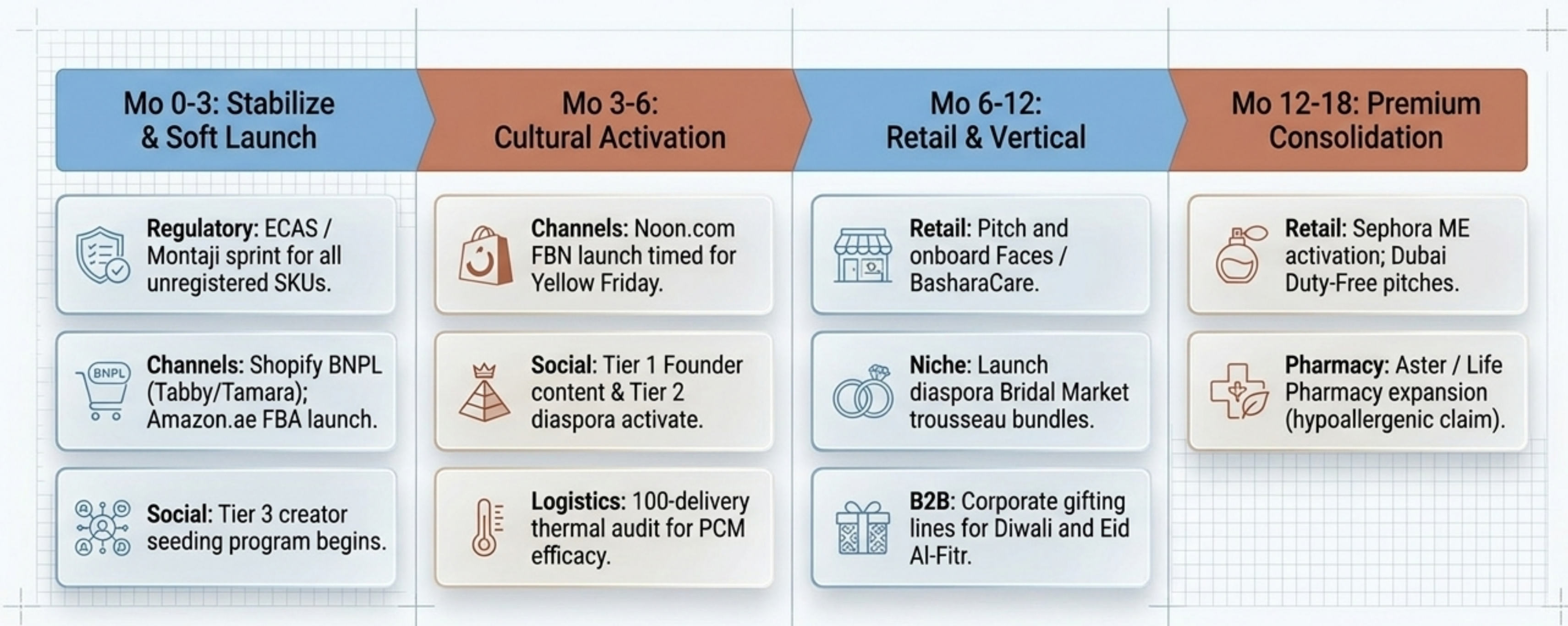
Profile: Micro/Nano seeding (Under 50K followers)
Volume: 30-60 / qtr
Objective: Authentic UGC, primary revenue driver

The Mathematics of Influence

Only Revenue Counts.

Implement a strict 1.5x ROAS threshold to maintain paid relationships. Creators who generate 10+ orders graduate to paid tiers; underperformers are dropped to gifting-only.

18-Month Execution Blueprint.



Execution of this blueprint transitions ZERO Makeup from a single-channel entrant into a highly defended, \$2.1M+ multi-channel ecosystem.